

Tillage Crop Production

Land Sciences

May, 2026

Tillage Crop Production (A08381)

Short Title: Tillage Crop Production
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Land Sciences
Cluster Agriculture
Author DFEWER
Credits 5

Level: Introductory

Description of Module / Aims

This module will enable the student to acquire principles, knowledge and skills needed to grow and manage common tillage crops, including cereals, alternative combinable crops, potatoes and forage crops. It will provide students with an in-depth overview of tillage crop production, and provide the practical experience of monitoring tillage crops.

Programmes

PROD-0004	BSc (Hons) in Agricultural Science (WD_SAGRI_B)	2 / 4 / M
PROD-0004	BSc in Agriculture (WD_SAGUL_D)	1 / 2 / M

Indicative Content

- Market outlets and quality standards
- Rotation and crop establishment
- Variety selection
- Plant nutrition and plant growth regulators
- Plant pests and control
- Plant diseases and control
- Weeds and their control
- Harvesting and storage
- Economics of crop production

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Describe market outlets and quality standards for tillage crops.
2. Explain crop rotations and establishment of tillage crops.
3. Describe variety selection and its role in crop management.
4. Describe crop nutrition and plant growth regulators.
5. Identify a range of crop pests, diseases and weeds.
6. Describe a range of pests, diseases and weeds and appropriate control strategies.
7. Describe the harvesting and storage of crops.
8. Discuss the economics of crop production.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Practical instruction.
- Practical demonstrations.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	50%	1,2,3,4,6,7,8,
Continuous Assessment	50%	
<i>Practical</i>	25%	5
<i>In-Class Assessment</i>	25%	3,4,8

Assessment Criteria

- <40%:** Very little knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Unable to carry out critical thinking or practical skills.
- 40%-49%:** Demonstrate a limited knowledge of the subject matter. May have some problems with critical thinking and problem-solving. Adequate practical skills.
- 50%-59%:** Demonstrate satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject. Good practical skills.
- 60%-69%:** Demonstrate skilled and sound knowledge of the subject matter. Show ability to analyse and logically discuss in an effective way. Good critical thinking and a high level of competence and efficiency in theoretical and practical areas of this subject.
- 70%-100%:** All of the above to an excellent level. Demonstrate authoritative handling of complex material and a highly developed and extensive understanding of the subject.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	36	
Practical	12	
Independent Learning	87	

Essential Material

- "Animal & Horticulture Development Board." <http://www.ahdb.org.uk/>
- "Teagasc." <http://www.teagasc.ie/>
- O'Dwyer, J. *_Combinable Crop Production Workbook_*. Piltown: Teagasc, 2013.